PRODUCT MANAGEMENT · LAB A

THE RISKIEST ASSUMPTION

Finding the belief that could break the business — and designing the questions to test it before it does.

ONIT · INDIVIDUAL WORK AND PARTNER REVIEW

6	₹10.5L	10%	8
assumptions ranked by kill-probability	booking value recorded in 30 days	commission in the proposed model	final customer-interview questions

Varun × Paul (Lab Partner)

SECTION 01

Six Assumptions

Ranked from highest to lowest kill-probability — the assumptions that could most seriously affect the ONIT model if they prove false.

1	Customers are willing to use an online platform to book home services.	KILL RISK — HIGHEST
2	Agencies have sufficient capacity to handle additional bookings.	KILL RISK
3	Agencies can consistently deliver the expected service quality.	KILL RISK
4	Customers face difficulties finding reliable home-service providers.	KILL RISK
5	ONIT can generate sustainable revenue from each booking.	KILL RISK
6	Agencies are willing to accept bookings through ONIT.	KILL RISK — LOWEST

Reading the bars: bar length shows rank order only — it is not a measured probability. #1 is the belief most likely to break ONIT if it is wrong.

SECTION 02

What I Believe / What I Know

This separates assumptions from evidence currently available.



4 beliefs not yet validated

2 known initial evidence only

"I know" means there is some direct evidence of initial activity; it does not mean the assumption is fully proven.

I KNOW

Online booking willingness

Customers have placed bookings through ONIT's online platform. This confirms initial usage, but repeat usage and broader willingness still need validation.

I BELIEVE

Agency capacity

ONIT works with existing service agencies. Their spare capacity to absorb additional demand has not been fully validated.

I BELIEVE

Consistent service quality

The model depends on partner agencies fulfilling jobs. Consistent quality across bookings has not yet been established.

I BELIEVE

Customer discovery problem

ONIT recorded approximately ₹10.5 lakh in booking value within 30 days. This shows initial activity, but does not independently prove the customer problem.

I BELIEVE

Sustainable revenue per booking

The proposed model includes a 10% commission. Sustainable unit economics have not yet been demonstrated.

I KNOW

Agency willingness

ONIT has existing agency relationships and has received bookings through its platform. This is evidence of initial participation, not proof of consistent fulfilment.

SECTION 03

Top Assumption to Test

ASSUMPTION 01

Customers must be willing to use an online platform to book home services.

The existing bookings show some initial online usage. The interviews should explore what customers have **actually done**, without mentioning ONIT or asking what they might do in future.

Explore

- What customers have **actually done** in real, past situations.
- Open questions about real experiences — “never” is a valid answer.
- Let the person describe what happened in their own words.

Avoid

- Mentioning or explaining ONIT.
- Asking what customers **might do** in future.
- Pitching the platform or suggesting online booking is better.

SECTION 04

Interview Questions — Varun

Eight draft questions for the customer interview, written to uncover real past behaviour.

1. Think about the last time you needed a plumber, electrician or cleaning service. How did you find them?
2. What made you choose that particular service provider?
3. Have you ever tried booking a home service through an app or website? How was the experience?
4. Have you ever decided not to book a service after finding it online? What happened?
5. Which websites or apps have you used most recently to find local services? What did you do there?
6. Can you tell me about the last time an online booking process was confusing or difficult to complete?
7. Have you ever compared the price of a home service online with the price quoted over a phone call? What happened?
8. After your last home-service booking, how did you contact the provider again, if at all?

SECTION 05

Interview Questions — Paul

Eight draft questions from Paul, the lab partner.

1. When was the last time you booked a home service by calling someone directly? How did it go?
2. Have you ever booked a home service through a mobile app? Can you walk me through what happened?
3. The last time you needed a home service, how did you check whether the person was trustworthy?
4. Have you ever faced a situation where you couldn't get a home service booked when you needed one? What did you do?
5. Can you describe the last time you asked someone else to arrange a home service on your behalf?
6. What happened the last time a service provider changed the agreed price after you contacted them?
7. Have you ever paid for a home service online? Tell me about the most recent time.
8. Can you recall the last time you cancelled or rescheduled a home-service appointment? What led to it?

SECTION 06

Partner Strike

The partner review removes questions that are leading, assume an experience, overlap with another question, or are less useful for testing the selected assumption.

QUESTION	DECISION	REASON FOR STRIKE / KEEP
Varun 1	KEEP	Open question about a real past experience.
Varun 2	KEEP	Explores the respondent's actual choice.
Varun 3	KEEP	Tests past online booking experience; "never" is a valid answer.
Varun 4	STRIKE	Assumes the respondent found a service online and considered not booking; overlaps with other online experience questions.
Varun 5	STRIKE	Too broad and not necessarily about booking home services; may drift into general app usage.
Varun 6	STRIKE	Frames the online process as confusing or difficult, which may lead the respondent towards a negative answer.
Varun 7	STRIKE	Combines two price channels and assumes the respondent compared them.
Varun 8	STRIKE	Assumes there was follow-up contact after the booking; less direct for testing initial online booking willingness.
Paul 1	KEEP	Explores an actual offline booking method.
Paul 2	STRIKE	Duplicates Varun 3 by asking about past app-based home-service booking.
Paul 3	KEEP	Explores a real trust-checking behaviour.
Paul 4	KEEP	Past-focused and allows the respondent to describe what they did when booking failed.
Paul 5	STRIKE	Focuses on arranging services for another person, which is less direct to the respondent's own booking behaviour.
Paul 6	STRIKE	Assumes the provider changed the agreed price; also shifts focus to pricing disputes.
Paul 7	STRIKE	Assumes an online payment and overlaps with online booking experience.
Paul 8	STRIKE	Assumes a cancellation or rescheduling event and is less direct to the top assumption.

SECTION 07

Final Eight Questions

The questions retained for the customer interview — split between Varun and Paul, with no repeated question.

VARUN — 4 QUESTIONS

1. Think about the last time you needed a plumber, electrician or cleaning service. How did you find them?
2. What made you choose that particular service provider?
3. Have you ever tried booking a home service through an app or website? How was the experience?
4. Have you ever faced a situation where you couldn't get a home service booked when you needed one? What did you do?

PAUL — 4 QUESTIONS

1. When was the last time you booked a home service by calling someone directly? How did it go?
2. The last time you needed a home service, how did you check whether the person was trustworthy?
3. Can you describe the last time you asked someone else to arrange a home service on your behalf?
4. Can you recall the last time you cancelled or rescheduled a home-service appointment? What led to it?

INTERVIEW REMINDER

Keep the conversation natural. Do not explain ONIT, pitch the platform, or suggest that online booking is better. Let the person describe what actually happened.